



University College Dublin
An Coláiste Ollscoile Baile átha Cliath

COMP3030J Software Engineering Project

Lecture 4

Prof Catherine Mooney



UCD School of Computer Science



University College Dublin
An Coláiste Ollscoile Baile átha Cliath

Overview

Project Proposals

Mid-semester progress assessment



Project Proposals

- Think of this project proposal as your opportunity to “pitch” your ideas to your client/customer
- Your pitch should be a brief (approximately 2-page PDF) outline of how you plan to address the client’s requirements and the time frame for doing this
- This will not be individually graded, but should be seen as an opportunity to think about your customer’s requirements and your plan for the semester
- Upload to Moodle by midnight on Friday at the end of Week 5



Project Proposals

- “Selling” an exciting idea is never an easy task
- Sometimes, it's not your idea that the company don't like, it's the manner in which it was presented
- Your project proposal is an opportunity to present a software solution to the problem that the customer specified in the problem statement
- Your challenge is to create a project proposal that can persuade the client to do business with you!



Project Requirements

- Review the “Problem Statement” on Moodle
- Your projects must meet the minimum requirements stipulated by the problem statement.
- You must demonstrate how you meet the requirements in your project proposals.



Requirements

What are the attributes of good software?

- Good software should deliver the required functionality and performance to the user and should be maintainable, dependable, secure, efficient and usable.

Additional Requirements: networking, storage, front-end interface, etc...



Additional Considerations

How will you make your software available for remote testing?



Project Proposals

Project Proposal Writing: How To Write A Winning Project Proposal

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jsGBuu88WE0>

- Problem
- Vision
- Benefits
- Deliverables
- Success criteria – SMART
- Deadlines (Gantt)/plan (WPs)/approach (Agile/Waterfall/etc.)
- Cost/budget/team requirements



SMART Goals

SMART project management goals:

- Specific – target a specific area for improvement.
- Measurable – quantify or at least suggest an indicator of progress.
- Achievable – specify who will do it.
- Realistic – state what results can realistically be achieved, given available resources.
- Time-related – specify when the result(s) can be achieved.



Assessment

- **Mid-semester progress assessment (20%)** A 4-minute (max) video on group progress through Week 7 (submitted Week 8): What have you done? What do you plan to do? What challenges have you encountered so far, and how will you overcome them? We will also look at your progress on the Overleaf report.
- This will be presented live in front of the class in Week 9.



Presentation Tips

- How to make a successful presentation: 5 easy steps to perfection
<https://www.articulatemarketing.com/blog/how-to-make-a-successful-presentation>
- Presentation Skills
<https://student-learning.tcd.ie/learning-resources/presentation/>



With your TAs

Review:

- Have all VMs been deployed?
- Start writing your Project Proposals
 - 2 pages, PDF, Friday Week 5
- Review the Presentation Tips
- Weekly Update



Recommended Reading

Cooperative Software Development

by Prof Amy J. Ko, University of Washington, Seattle

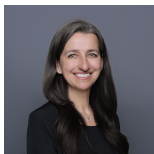
An excellent book on software development which focuses on the many ways that software engineering work is cognitive, social, and organisational.

<https://faculty.washington.edu/ajko/books/cooperative-software-development/>



Any Questions? Email me...

catherine.mooney@ucd.ie



- If you email me, please use your UCD Connect email address.
- Please put "Question about COMP3030J" in the subject line.
- Please put the following in your email template:

Dear Prof Catherine,

*My name is X (UCD Student number X). I am a member of Group X.
(Explain what your questions are here...)*

Many thanks,

Your Name